



Opera Unite

Opera's new service allows users to host web pages, share music and even chat on their browser



End to rights!

Moby calls for the Recording Industry Association of America (RIAA) to be disbanded

Brand	AVG	ESET	F-Secure	G DATA	K7
Product	Internet Security 8.5	Smart Security 4	Internet Security 2009	InternetSecurity 2010	InternetSecurity 9.0
Price	Rs. 1,999 (out soon)	Rs. 2,879	Rs. 1,154 (1 yr, 1 PC)	Rs. 1,500 (1 yr, 1 PC)	Rs. 1,678 (1 yr, 1 PC)
Features (Out of 35)	31.5	28	31.5	33.25	33.25
Performance (Out of 65)	32.11	44.77	35.51	37.02	40.36
Overall (Out of 100)	63.61	72.77	67.01	70.27	73.61
Features					
Antivirus	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Firewall	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Anti-spyware	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Data and Identity protection	Y	N	N	N	Y
Instant messenger protection	Y	N	N	Y	N
Ad/popup blocker	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Parental Controls	N	N	Y	Y	Y
Performance					
Virus and spam detection	527	265	292	288	290
Infections detected (Out of 7)	0	0	0	0	0
Vulnerability mails (Out of 10)	0	6	0	0	0
Spam					
IP bombing attacks (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Port scan (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Ads/popups blocked (Y/N)	N	N	Y	N	N
Memory consumption (Idle) (MB)	82.6	53	90	41	28
Memory consumption (Activity) (MB)	82.6	55	133	104	124



banners and popups effectively. The others weren't able to stop the ads or popups. For now, it's still recommended that users use alternatives to Internet Explorer.

Performance

Most security suites run many background services each of which consume a lot of memory. Kaspersky had few services running in the background in comparison to the other suites. On idle, the consumption was a tiny 30 MB of system memory. However, while scanning this

consumption went right up to 150 MB. This version of Kaspersky Internet Security suite is a big improvement over earlier Kaspersky products.

eScan Internet Security allows users to turn down the process priority of the scan so system performance isn't affected a lot. Even without the CPU utilisation level altered, eScan takes considerably longer to scan and clean viruses. In our test, 10 MB of files with some 289 viruses took around 5 minutes to complete. Disinfecting speed usually isn't a priority for most users.

ESET Smart Security and Norton 360 were also very light suites to run at all times. ESET Smart Security was particularly impressive as it only consumed some 55 MB of system memory while scanning the drive, which is a lot lower than the rest which used over 100 MB of memory. K7 TotalSecurity too consumed under 30 MB of memory while idle, but went to as high as 124 MB during scans.

eScan Internet Security and McAfee Internet Security were some of the suites with the most features and the memory consumption also showed. If you have systems with over 1 GB memory, you should have no problem running these suites. With 512 MB, you might notice some slowdown.

G DATA InternetSecurity 2010's memory consumption was constantly around the 100 MB mark. It would occasionally shoot up to 200 MB or more and come right down. When it isn't scanning, it's a very sane and stable security solution to use. There are two virus scanning engines in G DATA, both of which can be used for better performance or better detection. It's a unique feature

missing in other suites. AVG was a consistent 82 MB on idle and also with some scanning operations on. CPU utilisation kept spiking randomly as well while constantly trying to validate certain files.

Panda Internet Security had considerably high resource consumption at all times. There was an option in the preferences window that let CPU load be dropped to allow other tasks to run simultaneously without any major performance hit.

Ease of use

Security suites are some of the most complicated piece of software you can find. There are too many controls which have all been stuffed into a tiny interface. They have to be practical while not being overly complicated for the end user. Of all the suites, we found that Norton 360 had the simplest approach. Like the antivirus program that we've all seen over the year, Norton 360 is now a very easy to understand application with four separate sections – PC security, Identity protection, Backup and PC Tuneup. The controls are now